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DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE yesterday strongly condemned Iran's missile attack on two UAE national oil tankers in the Strait of Hormuz that killed an Indian crew member and injured several others, as US President Donald Trump abruptly scrapped his proposed 20 per cent fee on ships using the strategic waterway while maintaining a naval blockade on Iranian ports.

The UAE Ministry of Foreign Affairs described the attack on MT Mombasa and MT Al Bahiyah as a flagrant violation of international law and UN Security Council Resolution 2817, which guarantees freedom of navigation and condemns attacks on commercial shipping.

The UAE Ministry of Defence said two Iranian cruise missiles struck the tankers while they were transiting the southern shipping lane of the Strait of Hormuz in Omani territorial waters. One Indian crew member was killed and eight others were injured, including four critically. The injured included six Indians and two Ukrainians.

Significant damage

The strikes also caused significant damage to both vessels after fires broke out on board, although the fires were later brought under control.

The Defence Ministry said the UAE "reserves its full right to respond" and take all necessary measures to protect its territory, citizens, residents and strategic assets. Adnoc Logistics & Services confirmed that its owned tanker Al Bahiyah and the time-chartered Mombasa B sustained significant damage and said it was working with emergency responders.

Hours later, Trump reversed his plan to impose a 20 per cent US reimbursement fee on ships transiting the Strait of Hormuz.

UAE SLAMS IRAN TANKER ATTACK; TRUMP DROPS HORMUZ FEE PLAN

Indian crew member killed as GCC and India condemn strike; US keeps blockade on Iranian ports



"I have decided to replace the 20 per cent United States Reimbursement Fee with Trade and Investment Deals that the various Gulf States will be making into the United States," Trump wrote on Truth Social, saying the decision followed "highly productive conversations with Middle East leadership."

However, he said Washington would continue a "FULL Blockade" on ships travelling to and from Iranian ports or carrying Iranian cargo.

Strong protest

India summoned Iran's deputy chief of mission in New Delhi and lodged a strong protest over the attacks.

The Gulf Cooperation Council also condemned what it de-

scribed as Iran's aggressive attack on the UAE tankers, while the UAE separately denounced Iranian missile and drone attacks on Bahrain and Jordan, reaffirming its full solidarity with both countries.

Meanwhile, fighting between the US and Iran intensified, with Iranian media reporting fresh US strikes on Bushehr, Bandar Abbas, Abadan and Mahshahr. Brent crude rose about 5 per cent as renewed fighting fuelled concerns over energy supplies through one of the world's most important shipping lanes.

Late on Monday, Kuwait's military said it intercepted hostile aerial targets after they entered the country's airspace.

— With WAM, AP, AFP inputs
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LIMITED FLIGHT DISRUPTIONS

Fresh security warnings and limited flight disruptions have emerged across the Gulf as tensions between the US and Iran continue to affect regional travel. The European Union Aviation Safety Agency (EASA) has advised European airlines to avoid the airspace of the UAE, Bahrain, Kuwait and Qatar, citing a "high risk" to civil aviation.

The latest Conflict Zone Information Bulletin (CZIB), issued yesterday, is valid until July 29 unless reviewed earlier. It also covers airspace over the western part of the Gulf of Oman. The UK also updated its travel advice for the UAE, urging British nationals to keep travel plans under review, while the US State Department and the US Mission to the UAE warned American citizens of potential hostilities and aerial threats, advising them to follow local authorities' instructions.

The tensions have also disrupted some flights. Flydubai cancelled two Dubai-Abha services and their return flights yesterday after Yemen's Houthi militants targeted Saudi Arabia's Abha International Airport. Air Arabia also cancelled its Abha-Sharjah flight, while FlightRadar24 showed several domestic Saudi flights were also called off.

— Dhanusha Gokulan, Chief Reporter

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England vs Argentina: A rivalry rooted in conflict

Falklands war cast a long shadow over clashes on the pitch

DUBAI

BY ROBERT ILSLEY
Sports Reporter



"A football game, that's all," said Argentina coach Lionel Scaloni ahead of their blockbuster clash with England.

A World Cup match between these two fierce rivals is never really just a football game, as they meet for the first time in over two decades in the 2026 Fifa World Cup semi-final tonight in Atlanta.

With a place in the World Cup final at stake, this fixture could hardly be any bigger, yet the long-standing rivalry between England and Argentina adds an extra layer of intrigue.

The roots of the football rivalry between England and Argentina lie not on the pitch, but in the South Atlantic.

In April 1982, Argentina invaded the Falkland Islands, a British Overseas Territory known in Argentina as the Islas Malvinas, triggering a 10-week conflict with the United Kingdom. Although football

matches between the two nations had been competitive before then, the Falklands War gave every subsequent meeting far greater significance.

Encounters between England and Argentina came to be viewed through the lens of that conflict, with heightened emotion among players, supporters and the media. More than four decades later, the war remains the defining backdrop to one of international football's most intense and enduring rivalries.

Just four years after the Falklands War, England and Argentina were drawn together in the quarter-finals of the 1986 World Cup in Mexico.

Given the conflict between the two nations, the match carried enormous significance beyond football and quickly became one of the most watched and talked-about games in World Cup history.

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